



Module 2:

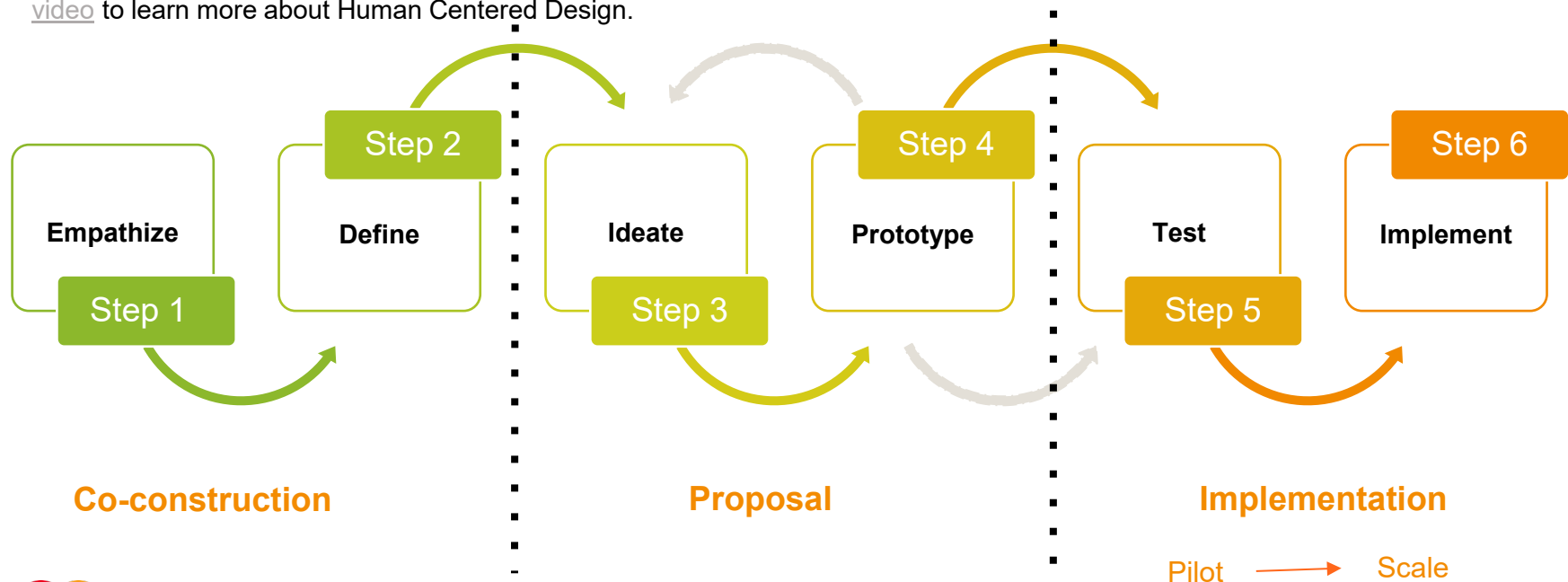
Centering Young Women

in our Programs



YWC Process

The design process is iterative and non-linear. These are six key steps part of the design process. You can watch [this video](#) to learn more about Human Centered Design.



Module 2 Content

Module 2 will focus on the **Ideation phase (Step 3: Ideate, Step 4: Prototype)** and **Implementation Phase (Step 5 : Test, Step 6: Implementation)**

Guided by our **Personas** and **Problem Statement**; we will redefine the **Theory of Change** by looking at:

- Barriers & Assumptions
- Risks and Safeguarding
- Program Goal & Outcomes
- Evaluating Interventions

Module 2 Content

This will lead to us developing:

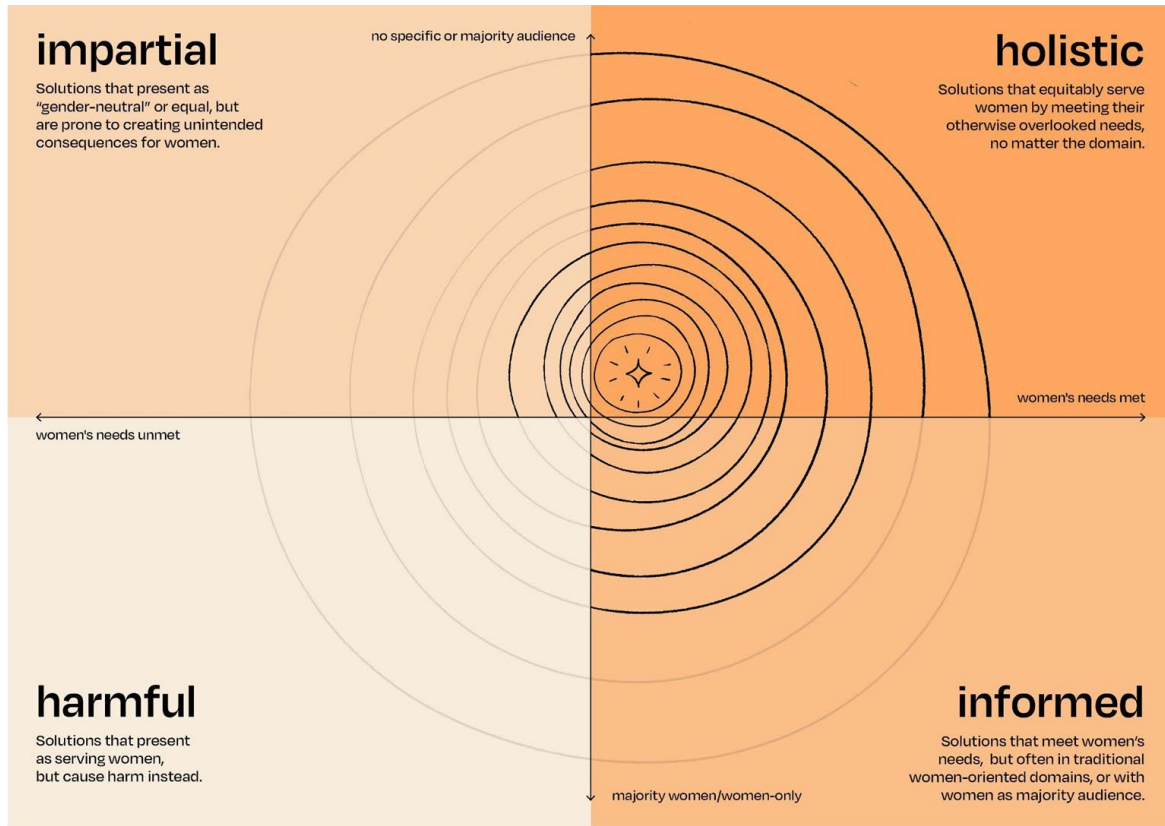
- Young Women-Centered Theory of Change (Re-looking at your barriers and Interventions and activities)
- Focus will be on opportunities for deepening from a Young women Centric
- Young Women-Centered Implementation Roadmap/ Workplan

Let's take the help of a tool: The **women centric Eye**

The eye is a tool to help us evaluate the outcomes and consequences of our interventions. Once we are able to evaluate our interventions and understand the consequences, we can design better, more holistic interventions. The matrix has four categories: harmful, impartial, informed and holistic, and first let's learn about each of them.

([Watch the instructional video for the matrix here](#))

Credit: from the **Women-Centric Eye** by **Unconform**

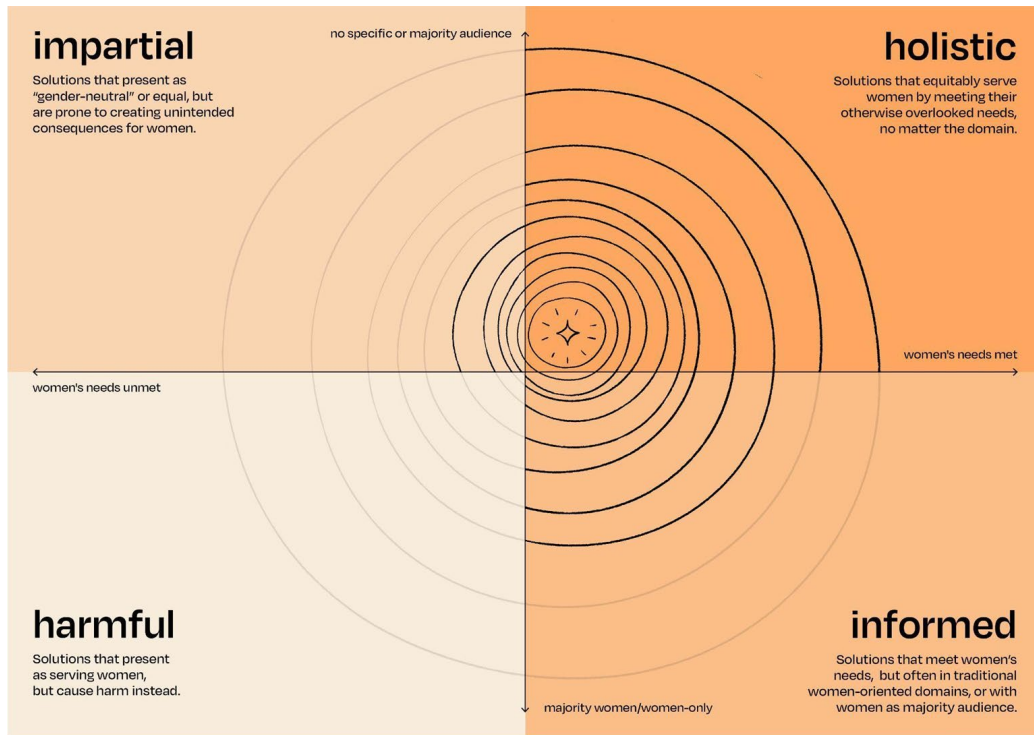


UNCONFORM



Evaluate your interventions

If you need help, [watch the instructional video for the matrix here](#)



Step 1: Write one intervention per post it note



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Step 2: Drag the post its according to where you think it belongs on the Eye?

Exercise

Take a look at your existing interventions. Where would you place each of them and why? (on next page)



Redefining our Program Goal with Barriers Interventions and Assumptions

Barriers

To center young women in our programs, we must understand their lived experience in work

What are their hopes, desires, aspirations?

What challenges do they face?

What are their barriers to entry and to stay in work?

Barriers

Why are barriers important?

What can understanding barriers help us with?

1. Improved understanding of the real problem

2. Assumptions we have about the barriers

3. Re-adjusting our program goal

Understanding lived experience & barriers

This empathy & barriers map is a tool to help you understand your personas even better. For each section, use the questions to write down what you know about your persona (there is a fillable version on the next page)

THINK & FEEL

- *What fears / anxieties do young women have about accessing finance from the sacco?*
- *What personal challenges impede their access?*
- ***How do societal expectations and gendered norms influence their thoughts/feelings about sacco?***

SAY & DO

- ***What specific actions are they taking to access finance from the Sacco? Eg joining Young women and Youth groups, being members of a farmers association (Coffee farmers association)***
- ***Are there barriers to access and benefit from the Sacco? Do they discuss openly?***
- *How do they manage barriers? What support systems do they rely on?*

SEE

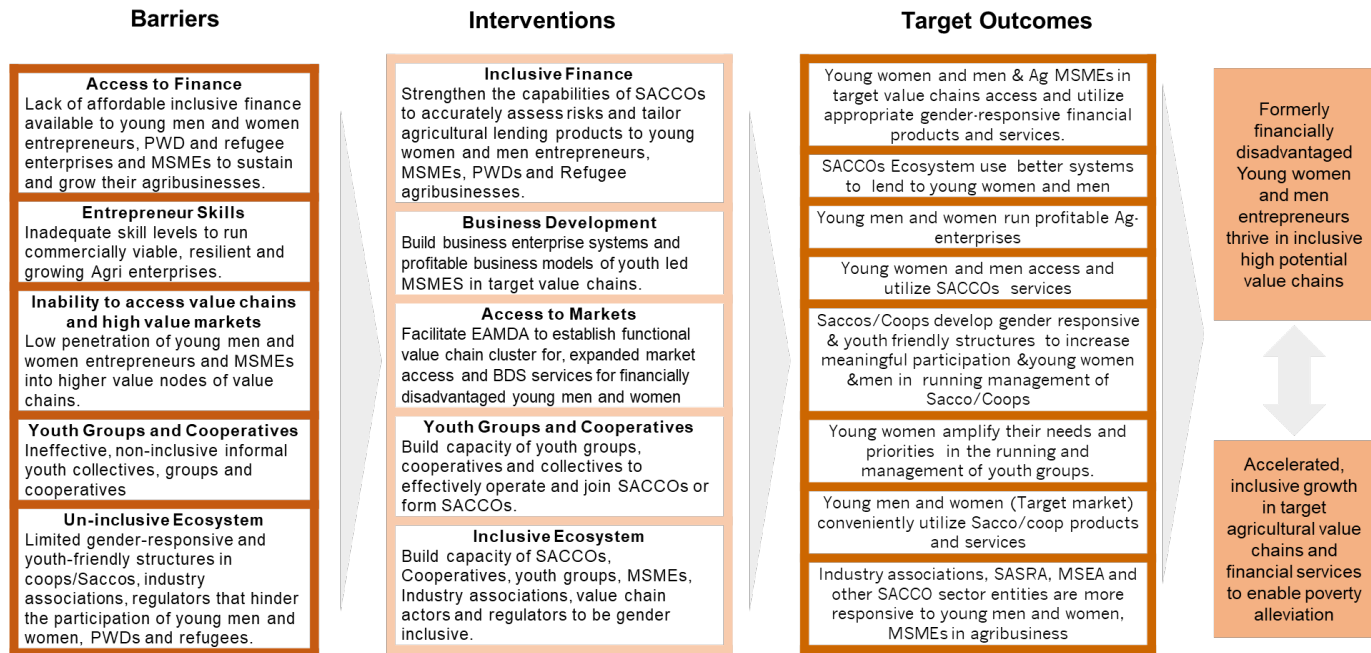
- *What opportunities are visible to them once they benefit from the Sacco?*
- ***How do sacco environments appear to them? (inclusive, welcoming, scary?)***
- *How does the representation of women in sacco leadership impact how they view the Sacco?*

Who is the young woman? What are her **hopes & aspirations?** What **barriers** prevent her from achieving these?

HEAR

- *What message do they hear from family, friends and media, farmer associations, about Young women participation in the Sacco?*
- *If they have role models, what are they saying? What are the gatekeepers saying?*
- ***How do cultural narratives shape young women's understanding of what opportunities are available to them in the Sacco?***

TOC



Assumptions

What assumptions are we making based on our barriers?

Why are we talking about assumptions? Because they affect our understanding of young women's lived experiences.

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Checking our assumptions

As humans, we make assumptions about lots of things. Assumptions allow us to go through everyday life, but they can also be dangerous, especially when we are trying to design an experience that serves everyone.

Checking our assumptions is the same as being curious and being open to being wrong. It allows us to validate and invalidate hunches, understand the bigger picture and design a more holistic experience.

[Assumptions video link here](#)



Dangers of Assumptions

Misalignment with
User Needs

01.

Reinforcement of
Power Imbalances

02.

Perpetuation of
Stereotypes

03.

Ineffective solutions

04.

Homogenisation of
Users

05.

Unmet Needs

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Making Assumptions

- We all make assumptions
- It is necessary to keep an open mind by pausing, recognising and questioning our assumptions
- Use assumptions to help you craft curious questions to ask



Example:

Assumption: Young women cannot secure respectable, reliable and fulfilling employment opportunities because they lack vocational skills. Their lack of skill barrier is caused by their lack of access to vocational training programs.

Hypothesis: Offering affordable and accessible vocational training to young women will enable them to secure respectable and reliable employment, leading to increased economic stability and job satisfaction.

Testing Areas

- Interest in Vocational Training
- Impact of Training on Employment Opportunities
- Barriers to Accessing Training
- Perceived and Actual Values of Training....

Barriers, Associated Assumptions and Interventions

In the previous exercise, you articulated barriers after filling in the empathy map.

Now take another look at the barriers with the lens of assumptions. What assumptions did you make about the barriers – and how would you shift them now? Use the example below to help you fill out your assumptions on the next page.

Barriers Identified	Associated Assumptions	Interventions
<i>Access to Finance:</i>	<i>What is the associated assumption using the YWC Lense?</i>	22

Program Outcomes

Looking at your interventions from a YWCDA, what outcomes will help you determine if you are making true impact for young women in your program?

Write your outcomes here

1.

2.

3.

Exercise: Young Women Centered Theory of Change

Original Goal

Original Outcomes

Changes to interventions

YWC Goal

YWC Outcomes

Focus on Outcomes

Focus on Interventions

YWCD Implementation Roadmap

Now that you have you know how to center young women in our programs; what will you do differently in your program implementation?

Today/
Tomorrow

In a week

In a month

In a year

The YWC- Roadmap

Tomorrow	Next Week	By Next Month	By End of the Year

**Congratulations
on learning
YWCD!**

